



NCCA
ENTERTAINMENT INC.



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GENRE: Action-Thriller/Drama

Format: **Episodes:** 8 (One-Hour Episodes)

Tone: Eve's Bayou meets Chinatown by way of Greenleaf — a brooding, poetic thriller laced with gospel, guilt, and generational trauma.

Setting: Small-town Georgia — rich with religious ritual, Southern charm, and secrets buried beneath stained glass.

LOG LINE

When a disgraced FBI agent is assigned to protect a rising music mogul entangled in Atlanta's rap scene, he's unaware she's not just running from a criminal empire—she's maneuvering to take it over. In a world where every beat is a transaction and every betrayal is a remix, survival isn't enough. Monique wants legacy.

PITCH

The Line is an electrifying action drama blending high stakes thrills with poignant social commentary. Set against the vibrant, gritty backdrop of Atlanta's hip-hop culture, the series explores themes of loyalty, ambition, and trust through two dynamic leads. Their partnership, equal parts friction and camaraderie unfolds amid a conspiracy that connects Atlanta's music industry to its criminal underbelly.

With its rich character dynamics, authentic portrayal of culture, and edge-of-your-seat tension, The Line offers a fresh and timely narrative that resonates with a diverse audience.

Detailed Synopsis

After a fatal shooting at an Atlanta music label, FBI Agent Tom Whitaker is reassigned to protect Monique "Mo" Sanders, a fiercely independent music agent with deep ties to the rap scene and potentially the criminal underworld. Tom, a rule-following veteran with a tarnished reputation, is forced to embed himself in a culture he doesn't understand. Mo, a savvy survivor trying to protect her empire and her family, has no interest in government protection, until the threats turn deadly.

As Tom and Mo unravel a conspiracy connecting drug trafficking, political corruption, and the music industry, their personal differences evolve into reluctant respect and powerful alliance. Each episode pulls them deeper into a tangled web of lies, betrayal, and blurred moral lines. In the explosive season finale, they must risk everything to expose the truth, even if it means losing the people they love most.

SERIES STYLE

- The Wire meets Bodyguard

- Cinematic palette similar to *Atlanta* (FX) with neon cityscapes and gritty realism
- Noir-inspired framing—light and shadow, moral ambiguity
- Visual/tonal echoes of *Queen & Slim*, *Snowfall*, *Top Boy*, and *Greenleaf*
- Urban realism with moments of elegance and pressure—cars, corner stores, boardrooms, safehouses

SERIES TONE

- The high-octane intensity of *Bodyguard*
- The cultural depth of *Atlanta*
- The gritty, layered storytelling of *The Wire*

THE ARC

Episode Highlights:

- Episode 1: Tom and Mo's worlds collide after a near-fatal assassination attempt. Reluctantly partnered, they set out to uncover the truth.
- Episode 4: A shocking betrayal forces Tom and Mo to trust each other completely as threats escalate.
- Episode 7: The duo uncovers a conspiracy implicating powerful politicians and law enforcement, setting the stage for the explosive finale.
- Episode 8: In a climactic showdown, Mo and Tom dismantle a criminal empire but not without devastating personal sacrifices.

CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

- Agent Tom Whitaker (Mid-40s, White): A principled yet disillusioned FBI agent seeking redemption after a career scandal. Smart, disciplined, but emotionally closed off.

- Monique "Mo" Sanders (Late 20s, Black): A self-made music agent walking the line between success and survival. Fierce, strategic, and loyal but haunted by her past.
- JJ "Jimmy" Sanders (60s, Black): Mo's uncle, a former gang member turned mentor. Wise, protective, and willing to do whatever it takes to shield his family.
- Alonso "Skipper" Sanders (40s, Black): Mo's incarcerated brother, once a promising musician, now a bitter voice of street wisdom from prison.
- Dex Miles (30s, Black): Mo's on again/off again love interest, a music producer with possible cartel ties.
- Agent Rico Castillo (30s, Latino): Tom's ambitious rival at the Bureau, with his own stake in the case.

TALENT SUGGESTIONS

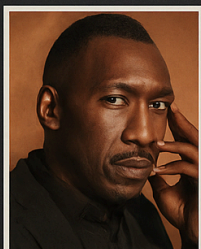
- Tom Whitaker: Jon Bernthal, Josh Lucas, Michael C. Hall
- Mo Sanders: Keke Palmer, Dominique Fishback, Ryan Destiny
- Jimmy Sanders: Wendell Pierce, Clifton Powell, Courtney B. Vance
- Dex Miles: Trevante Rhodes, Algee Smith
- Agent Castillo: Raúl Castillo, Rick Gonzalez

THE LINE

CASTING BOARD



Monique "Mo" Sanders
TESSA THOMPSON



Mahershala Ali
MAHERSHALA ALI



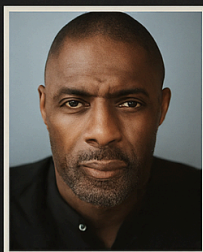
Angela Bassett
ANGELA BASSETT



Agent Karen Bailey
REGINA KING



Delroy Washington
DELROY LINDO



Kane Frost
KEKE PALMER



Jurnee Smollett
JURNEE SMOLLETT



Sterling K. Broun
STERLING K. BRONN
AGENT JACKSON
"TANK" WILLIAMS



Winston Duke
WINSTON DUKE



LaKeith Stanfield

PRODUCTION VALUE

- **Setting:** On-location shoots in Atlanta highlight the city's vibrant essence.
- **Soundtrack:** A dynamic mix of mainstream and underground rap artists enhances the immersive storytelling.
- **Visual Style:** Gritty realism interwoven with moments of urban glamour, echoing the energy of *Breaking Bad* and *Insecure*.

DIRECTOR MATCH SUGGESTIONS

- Reinaldo Marcus Green (We Own This City, King Richard)
- Victoria Mahoney (Lovecraft Country, The Old Guard 2)
-  Kasi Lemmons (Eve's Bayou, Harriet)
- DeMane Davis (Queen Sugar, Self Made)
- Greg Yaitanes (House, Banshee)

THEMES

1. Trust vs. Betrayal

At its core, *The Line* is a story about trust, earned, broken, and rebuilt. Tom and Mo begin on opposite sides of the system but must learn to rely on each other in a world where betrayal is currency.

"You can't survive this city without trusting the wrong people just long enough to get what you need."

2. Moral Ambiguity

Every character walks the line between right and wrong. The show challenges binary thinking about justice and crime, especially in systems built on systemic inequities.

"Doing the right thing might still get you killed. But doing nothing? That gets everyone else killed too."

3. Survival vs. Integrity

Mo wants legitimacy, but she was raised by the code of the streets. Tom clings to ideals, but learns quickly that playing clean doesn't always keep people alive. The question becomes: what are you willing to compromise to survive?

4. Cultural Clash and Connection

Tom is an outsider in a world shaped by race, history, and music. His journey of understanding, through mistakes, humility, and allyship, drives the show's emotional growth. Atlanta's culture isn't just a backdrop; it's the source of tension and transformation.

5. Legacy and Redemption

Both Tom and Mo carry the weight of their families, past failures, and reputations. Their arcs are about rewriting the narrative, breaking cycles, claiming power, and defining what legacy truly means.

6. Power and Corruption

From dirty cops and music moguls to politicians and gang leaders, The Line explores how power operates and how truth gets buried when everyone profits from the lie.

MARKETABILITY

High-Concept Hook with Genre Appeal

- Combines Bodyguard, level action with The Wire style storytelling
 - FBI protection detail meets music industry conspiracy, a familiar structure with a fresh twist
 - Appeals to both crime drama lovers and viewers hungry for culturally resonant stories
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Diverse, Dual-Protagonist Structure

Mo and Tom serve as entry points for very different audience segments:

Mo resonates with Black women, entrepreneurial characters, and audiences who appreciate street-to-boardroom stories.



Tom speaks to viewers of classic cop thrillers, procedural fans, and redemption-arc enthusiasts.

Their tension filled, slow-burn dynamic gives emotional weight and layered drama

Authentic Music Integration

- Atlanta's hip-hop scene is both setting and storytelling tool
 - Opportunity for original soundtrack releases, artist cameos, and viral music marketing
 - Each episode ends with a curated music moment, perfect for playlist branding and TikTok/YouTube content
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Social Relevance Without Preaching

- Tackles themes of systemic injustice, surveillance, identity, and legacy
 - Built-in discourse potential across social media and think pieces (policing, race, music industry exploitation)
 - Great candidate for post-show digital content and panel discussions
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Broad Audience Appeal

- For streamers: Serialized binge-worthy drama
 - For networks: Cable-ready with limited-location tension, character-led plots
 - For advertisers/brands: Atlanta as a lifestyle brand fashion, music, cars, nightlife
 - Appeals to fans of Snowfall, Top Boy, Queen of the South, Power, Bodyguard
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Franchise & Expansion Potential

- Possible Season 2: New enemies rise from the power vacuum
 - Spin-offs or limited side stories featuring Mo's agency clients, Tom's FBI past, or Jimmy's backstory
 - Potential for companion podcast or short-form prequel series
 - Topical: Reflects real-world church abuse scandals and political cover-ups
 - Thrilling: Pacing mixes noir investigation with high-emotion family reveals
 - Cinematic: Southern Gothic visuals (stained glass, graveyards, gospel music)
 - Culturally specific, broadly resonant: Faith, family, justice, and identity
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Lookbook or Mood Reel References

- **The Wire** meets **Bodyguard**
 - Cinematic palette similar to **Atlanta** (FX) with neon cityscapes and gritty realism
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Marketing Hooks & Promo-Ready Taglines

- "The streets raised her. The system betrayed him. Together, they're crossing the line."
- "Atlanta is a battlefield. Survival is the only rule."

- “One city. Two enemies. A thousand secrets.”
 - Music-driven trailer drops with original Atlanta-based artists
 - Digital “Who Do You Trust?” campaign interactive content with viewer choices
 - Street-style billboard rollouts blending music and federal surveillance themes
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Target Audience & Market:

- Streaming platforms: **Netflix, FX/Hulu, Prime Video, Max, Paramount+**
- Cable-ready for **BET, OWN, Starz**
- Fans of action-dramas, character-driven crime thrillers, and culturally rooted storytelling
- Viewers seeking **Black led narratives** that blend genre entertainment with real world stakes

Core Audience:

- Age 25–54, urban and suburban viewers
 - Fans of shows like *Power*, *Snowfall*, *Atlanta*, *Bodyguard*, *Queen of the South*
 - Black audiences, music lovers, action/crime genre fans
 - Viewers interested in stories of justice, identity, systemic corruption, and survival
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Why It Sells

- Unique premise: FBI protection drama meets the music industry underworld

- Fresh dynamic duo: Interracial partnership filled with tension, chemistry, and emotional evolution
 - Authenticity: Atlanta isn't just a setting, it's the culture, sound, and soul of the story
 - Action + Emotion: Balances explosive sequences with deeply personal stakes
 - Cultural and political relevance: Speaks to current conversations on race, policing, and survival systems
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Comparable Films & Series

Bodyguard

Snowfall

Queen & Slim

The Wire

Atlanta

Top Boy

Power

Greenleaf

Story & Hook – Why This Story Matters Now

The Line explores the razor thin boundary between justice and survival in a time when trust in institutions is fractured and loyalty is currency. It tackles race, class, and corruption through the lens of two deeply human protagonists trying to do right by their code, even if that code is written in the streets. It's a show about truth, legacy, and the price of crossing into each other's worlds.

Demographics

60% Black / multicultural

55% Female Viewership

45% Male Viewership

Strong Gen Z / Millennial crossover via music tie-ins and social commentary

U.S. urban centers, global cities with hip-hop scenes (London, Lagos, Johannesburg, Toronto)



THE LINE BUDGET
ASSUMPTIONS

10.09.25

Net Cost Per Ep: \$1,256,523

Schedule:

- 4 weeks soft prep
- 4 weeks hard prep
- 5 weeks shoot
 - 40 Shoot days
 - 5 Days per episode

Writer:

- WGA
- 3 Writers
- Show Runner

Director:

- DGA Directors

Production & Creative Assumptions:

- The budget assumes filming on location in Atlanta, GA
- 40 Shooting Days
- Assumes \$46K per Episodes Director Fee
- Cast is actualized based on outlines.

- Assumes 2 stunt days per episode
- Assumes \$500 Day for Production Designer
- 6 Person Art Department
- 3 Person Props Department
- \$80,000 Allowance Art Purchases/Rentals
- \$8,000 Allowance Prop Purchases/Rentals
- G&E. 4 & 4 each department
- 20 additional man days for pre rigs, etc..
- Allowance Specials (e.g. Jib, Steadi , etc...)
- \$2800 Week Grip Package (Stage and Truck packages combined)
- \$13,000 Week Electric Package (Stage and Truck packages combined)
- 7 new sets built, 2 swing sets, 4 partial rebuilds/rehab sets
- 5 weeks of construction, 3 weeks of electric/grip rigging
- 1 day of work on the LED wall (driving shots, end of series scene)
- 5 Person Wardrobe Department
- Seamstress 10 Days
- Assumes \$600 Day for Costume Designer
- \$72,000 Allowance Wardrobe Purchase
- \$ 2,000 Allowance Wardrobe Rentals
- DP does not operate
- DP Local Hire

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- 3 Camera Shoot
 - \$92,000 Cameral Allowance for rentals / lenses
 - Utility
 - Teamsters
 - Location allowance for practical & stage work
 - SAG 24 run residual included factoring residual prepay on overscale actors.
12 Run attached for reference
 - Post Production: \$506K
 - 3 Editors:\$168k
 - Allowance for 1 AE:
 - Allowance for Hard Drives:\$16k
 - Music costs : \$184k
- Tax Credit & Financial Assumption: \$1,807,401
- Georgia State Tax Credit